Money Leakage Audit

A line-by-line recovery system for debt interest, fees, subscriptions, insurance, tax penalties and operatin

MATRIX REPROGRAMMED - DETAILED WEALTH GUIDE

Reader outcome: Quantify annual leakage, recover the largest controllable losses and install prevention controls.

Best for: A household or small business that earns money but retains too little.

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Educational information only. No personalised financial, investment, legal or tax advice. No guaranteed outcomes.

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1. Build the leakage register

Export at least three months of bank, card, loan, platform and investment transactions.

Classify each outflow as essential, productive, protective, optional, avoidable or unknown.

Convert monthly and quarterly costs to annual amounts.

Record the contract end date, cancellation route and owner.

Investigate unknown charges before assuming fraud or legitimacy.

2. Debt interest leakage

List balance, rate, fees, remaining term, early-repayment terms and security.

Prioritise arrears consequences and high guaranteed interest cost.

Compare refinancing using total cost, not payment alone.

Stop adding new revolving debt while repaying old balances.

Never move secured debt or guarantees without understanding the new risk.

3. Banking, FX and payment leakage

Measure account fees, overdraft, card charges, merchant fees, transfer fees and

foreign-exchange spread.
Check whether multi-currency activity needs a better operational process.
Reconcile small recurring payment failures and duplicate merchant services.
Do not switch providers until deposit protection, access and service reliability are checked.

4. Investment leakage

Add product charges, platform fees, advice fees, spreads, transaction charges, FX and performance fees.
Measure turnover and tax consequences caused by unnecessary trading.
Identify cash drag, duplicate funds and unintended concentration.
Compare total cost with a suitable lower-cost alternative, not simply the cheapest product.

5. Insurance leakage

List every policy, insured risk, limit, excess, exclusions, beneficiary and renewal date.
Find duplicate coverage and missing catastrophic coverage separately.
Compare policy value, not premium alone.
Cancel only after replacement coverage is active when the risk is essential.

6. Subscription and lifestyle leakage

Identify subscriptions unused for 30, 60 and 90 days.

Separate intentional quality-of-life spending from forgotten spending.

Create waiting periods for new recurring commitments.

Use annual cost in the purchase decision.

Lifestyle choices are not automatically waste; the audit asks whether spending matches a deliberate priority.

7. Tax and penalty leakage

Record late fees, missed allowances, poor records, incorrect regimes and unclaimed legitimate expenses.

Calendar filing, payment, renewal and evidence deadlines.

Fund tax cash separately.

Do not use aggressive schemes to recover ordinary administrative leakage.

8. Housing, energy and transport leakage

Compare finance, insurance, maintenance, energy, tax and opportunity cost - not one

monthly payment.
Measure underused space, avoidable journeys, vehicle downtime and contract mismatch.
Prioritise safety and reliability before lowest cost.
Model switching cost and disruption before changing essential services.

9. Business operating leakage

Measure unbilled work, scope creep, late payment, defects, returns, stock loss, unused software and idle equipment.
Track gross margin by customer, product and channel.
Set approval limits and purchase ownership.
Recover cash from slow stock, deposits, supplier terms and invoice follow-up without harming essential relationships.

10. Fraud and control leakage

Use multi-factor authentication, payment verification and separation of duties where possible.
Independently verify changed bank details.
Review account access and former staff permissions.
Treat unexpected urgency and secrecy as risk indicators.
Report suspected fraud promptly through the relevant bank, platform and authorities.

11. 30-day recovery plan

Week 1: build register and stop unknown or clearly unused costs.
Week 2: negotiate debt, insurance, banking and supplier terms.
Week 3: fix investment fees, tax records and business collection.
Week 4: install calendars, approval rules and monthly review.

[ ] Annual leakage identified.

[ ] Annual leakage recovered.

[ ] One-off recovery cost.

[ ] Prevention control owner.

12. How to use this guide

Purpose: Quantify annual leakage, recover the largest controllable losses and install prevention controls.
Best reader: A household or small business that earns money but retains too little.
Read the guide once without taking action. On the second pass, complete the checklists and write down the evidence supporting each decision.
Replace every example number with your own verified amount, date, fee, tax treatment, contract term or source document.
Do not treat a checklist tick as proof. Keep copies of the underlying statements,

quotations, filings, contracts and calculations.
For major decisions, use this guide to prepare better questions for a regulated adviser, accountant, lawyer, lender or insurer.

13. Evidence standard

Tier 1: law, regulator, tax authority, court, audited accounts, official product document or signed contract.
Tier 2: recognised institutional research that states its methodology, date and limitations.
Tier 3: reputable reporting used to identify questions, not to replace primary evidence.
Tier 4: marketing, social posts, testimonials, screenshots and anonymous claims. Treat these as unverified leads.
Write the source date beside every changing figure. A correct figure without a date can become misleading.
Separate facts, estimates, assumptions and scenarios. Never allow a scenario to be presented as a forecast or guarantee.
A company, fund, adviser, trust, structure, transaction or association is not proof of misconduct.

14. Decision record worksheet

[ ] State the decision in one sentence.

[ ] State the desired result and deadline.

[ ] List the three strongest pieces of supporting evidence.

[ ] List the three strongest reasons the decision may fail.

[ ] Record the maximum acceptable loss of money, time and flexibility.

[ ] Record the smallest reversible test.

[ ] Name the person responsible for checking legal, tax or regulatory consequences.

[ ] Set the next review date and the evidence that would cause you to stop.

15. Professional advice triggers

Seek regulated investment advice when product suitability, risk capacity, pensions, insurance or a large portfolio decision is unclear.

Seek tax advice before changing residence, extracting company cash, transferring assets, using trusts, gifting substantial sums or entering cross-border arrangements.

Seek legal advice before signing guarantees, shareholder agreements, acquisition contracts, complex leases, loan security or beneficiary arrangements.

Seek accounting advice when turnover, VAT, payroll, inventory, multiple activities or company-group transactions become material.

Use a defined written question. Paying for broad reassurance without documents or calculations rarely produces a useful answer.

16. Subject focus map

Use the following subject anchors as named checkpoints. For each checkpoint, record the fact, source, date, assumption, decision and next review date.

LEAKAGE REGISTER: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

ANNUAL COST: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

RECOVERY ACTION: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

PREVENTION CONTROL: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

Do not mark a checkpoint complete because an action was taken. Mark it complete only when the result and supporting evidence have been recorded.

Where a checkpoint depends on another person, institution, platform or contract, record that dependency and a fallback route.

Rank checkpoints by potential harm if ignored, not by how interesting or easy they appear.

At the end of each review, choose one checkpoint to advance and one risk to reduce before adding a new objective.

17. Worked decision case

Write a real decision from your own situation at the top of a blank page. Examples include changing work, launching an offer, choosing an account, buying an asset, restructuring a business or rejecting a proposal.

Baseline: state the current cash, income, liabilities, commitments, ownership, legal position and time available. Use documents rather than memory where possible.

Desired result: describe the measurable outcome, deadline and reason. Remove vague language such as more, better, passive, safe or guaranteed.

Options: include the proposed action, a smaller reversible test, a diversified alternative, delaying the action and doing nothing.

Evidence: attach at least three independent sources. Identify which evidence is official, contractual, audited, estimated, promotional or missing.

Economics: show setup cost, recurring cost, cash timing, fees, tax reserve, downside loss, opportunity cost and the point at which the decision becomes worthwhile.

Risk: identify concentration, liquidity, legal, operational, fraud, health, relationship and behavioural risks. Name the risk that could create irreversible harm.

Professional review: write the exact question that requires an accountant, lawyer, regulated adviser, lender, insurer or technical specialist.

Decision: state proceed, test, delay or reject. Record the maximum commitment and the evidence required before any further commitment.

Review: set a dated checkpoint. Write the result that would confirm the decision, the result that would require adjustment and the result that would trigger an immediate stop.

18. 90-day implementation workbook

Week 1 - Establish the baseline. Reconcile the relevant accounts, contracts, statements, fees, tax records, responsibilities and deadlines.

Week 2 - Define the result. Choose one measurable outcome and remove actions that do not directly support it or protect an essential risk.

Week 3 - Gather primary evidence. Use official registers, filings, signed terms, current quotations and dated institutional data.

Week 4 - Compare alternatives. Include a lower-cost option, a lower-risk option, a reversible test and the option to wait.

Week 5 - Model the economics. Build downside, base and upside cases while treating every uncertain input as an assumption.

Week 6 - Verify identity and authority. Confirm who owns, controls, advises, holds money, signs contracts and bears liability.

Week 7 - Run the smallest useful test. Limit money, time and legal commitment while collecting evidence about real demand or performance.

Week 8 - Reconcile actual results. Compare promised, expected and actual cost, time, cash flow, quality, risk and customer or counterparty behaviour.

Week 9 - Repair the constraint. Improve the single factor currently limiting income, retention, safety, liquidity, delivery or evidence quality.

Week 10 - Install controls. Add calendar reminders, approval limits, account separation, written procedures, backups and review ownership.
Week 11 - Decide whether to scale. Increase commitment only when the test produced measurable value and the downside remains affordable.
Week 12 - Complete the evidence file. Store the decision record, sources, calculations, contracts, results, lessons and next review date.
Day 90 - Write a one-page conclusion: what was established, what remains uncertain, what changed, what will continue and what will stop.

19. Review, escalation and stop rules

Review monthly when the decision affects recurring cash, debt, customer commitments, investment contributions or essential protection.
Review immediately after a material legal change, tax notice, contract change, security incident, missed payment, large loss, health event or relationship change.
Escalate to a qualified professional when the facts cross jurisdictions, involve regulated products, create personal guarantees, affect beneficiaries or cannot be reversed cheaply.
Pause when required documents are missing, identities cannot be independently verified, costs are unclear or the counterparty resists reasonable due diligence.
Stop when the action requires deception, undeclared income, false invoices, hidden beneficial ownership, unaffordable leverage or essential-living money.
Stop when actual cash use, delivery time or loss exceeds the written limit.

Stop when the central evidence is corrected, withdrawn, contradicted by a stronger source or no longer current.

Do not move a stop limit merely because money, pride or time has already been committed. Sunk cost is not evidence that continuing is rational.

Record every exception to the plan, who approved it and why. Repeated exceptions indicate the plan or control is not working.

A stopped action can still be a successful decision when it prevents a larger loss and preserves the ability to act later.

20. Evidence and legal boundary

This is educational information, not personalised financial, investment, legal, accounting or tax advice.

Investments can fall in value. Businesses can fail. Debt, leverage, illiquidity, tax and legal obligations can create losses greater than the expected benefit.

Rules and thresholds change. Verify the current official position on the date of action.

Never use false invoices, hidden ownership, undeclared income, sham transactions, misleading applications or borrowed essential-living money.

No return, saving, valuation, tax outcome or business result is guaranteed.

21. Official research routes

1. Banque de France - https://www.banque-france.fr/
2. AMF - Verify an authorisation - https://www.amf-france.org/fr/espace-epargnants/proteger-son-epargne/faire-les-verifications
3. impots.gouv.fr - Investment income - https://www.impots.gouv.fr/particulier/les-revenus-mobiliers
4. INSEE - https://www.insee.fr/
5. Entreprendre.Service-Public.fr - Business creation - https://entreprendre.service-public.fr/